ChatGPT

Agentic Demand Discovery for Multilingual Video Channels

Executive assessment

The strongest practical stack is **not one universal "agentic research" product**. The four questions in your brief are measured by different systems, and conflating them produces bad decisions. "What people watch," "what people search," "what is accelerating," and "what existing answers fail to satisfy" are separate signals. Google Trends measures relative Google-search interest; TikTok Creative Center primarily exposes hashtag/video/creative performance rather than user search volume; YouTube Studio Trends exposes YouTube search behavior and explicitly labels some search-result gaps; Pinterest Trends combines search/save/shopping behavior; Yandex Wordstat provides actual query-count statistics for Yandex; Naver DataLab exposes Korean search/shopping signals; and Baidu Index publishes a modeled search index rather than raw query counts. [1]

For a medium-capability agent fleet, I would use a **browser-first core** consisting of public Google Trends + public Pinterest Trends + native platform dashboards where account access exists, with an explicit fallback to ordinary browser inspection of search results, comments, transcripts and community discussions. Automation should be layered on only where the agent shell actually supports it. Of the three browser candidates you named, **Vercel `agent-browser` and Browserbase Stagehand's `browse` CLI are better fits for keyless local browser control than Browser Use's full agent library**: `agent-browser` is an outer-agent-driven CLI and can run against local Chrome without a model API; Stagehand's `browse ... --local` likewise says no LLM key or Browserbase account is required; Browser Use's local autonomous `Agent` normally needs an LLM provider or Browser Use model gateway, while its cloud browser adds a Browser Use API key and usage fees. [2]

The most important negative finding is that **there is no trustworthy public cross-platform "world ranking of demand"**. Relative 0–100 indices, bucketed Google Trending Now traffic, estimated monthly search volume, hashtag post counts, video views and provider-defined popularity scores are incompatible quantities. They should remain separate columns and be used for corroboration, not summed into a universal score. Google explicitly normalizes Trends to time/location and scales the result 0–100; Pinterest similarly normalizes its search trend series; Ahrefs' volume is a modeled 12-month average based on Google Keyword Planner data; Semrush describes its keyword volume as average monthly Google searches; TikTok Creative Center's trend pages expose posts/views for hashtags. [3]

Research check date: 8 November 2026, Europe/Athens. Live examples below are reported only where a current public page was actually retrievable; account-only products are not represented with invented "current tops."

Company-provided analytics: where to get fresh popular and rising queries

The following table is the independent deliverable you requested. “Popular,” “rising,” and “new” are kept distinct. A product appears here only if its current documentation or live interface provides a meaningful demand/attention signal; ad trends and entertainment charts are called out when they are *not* user-query data.

Company / product	Direct panel / report	Signal and metric	Locales	Useful windows	Update / freshness	Access / price
Google Trends — Trending Now	Trending Now	**Rising/new search queries**. Bucketed search traffic plus percentage growth versus a predicted baseline; “Started” time identifies when the surge began.	100+ countries/ regions. [4]	4h, 24h, 48h, 7d. No native 30/90d Trending-Now list. [4]	About every 10 minutes. [4]	Public/free; CSV, clipboard, RSS exports.
Google Trends — Explore	Explore	Relative search interest 0–100; **Top related searches** and **Rising related searches**; rising % compares with prior period, “Breakout” means >5,000%. [5]	Global down to regional/ city where data permits; terms can be language-specific or concepts can be multi-language Topics. [6]	Custom periods including 7/30/90d; very recent hourly data possible, but related Top/ Rising can have availability constraints for the newest dates. [7]	Near-real-time sampled data; Google says insights can be processed within minutes of real-world events. [8]	Public/free; CSV.

Company / product	Direct panel / report	Signal and metric	Locales	Useful windows	Update / freshness	Access / price
Google Trends BigQuery dataset	Official dataset instructions	Top 25 overall + Top 25 rising queries for past 30d, normalized/ aggregated.	US DMAs plus roughly 50 international countries. [9]	Rolling 30d rankings; US daily history 5y and hourly history 1y; international daily 5y. [9]	US hourly data 4× daily; international daily. [9]	BigQuery/ Google Cloud; query costs may apply beyond free allowances.
YouTube Studio — Trends tab	YouTube help / entry path	**Top searches** from your audience and saved topics over 28d; "Searched on YouTube"; audience interest; breakout videos; **Content gaps for Shorts** where viewers cannot find enough relevant/high-quality results. [10]	Some insights restricted by country, language and device. [10]	28d; not a configurable public 7/30/90d global leaderboard in current docs.	Account dashboard data; current help notes a Studio redesign rolling out from July 2026. [10]	Included with YouTube Studio/ channel account.
TikTok Creator Search Insights	In TikTok, search **"Creator Search Insights"**	Topics searched often; popularity score / Recommended Topic; **Content Gap** filter for topics searched often but represented by relatively few videos. [11]	TikTok says selected regions; availability is account/ region dependent. [11]	TikTok does not document a clean public 7/30/90d export comparable with Google Trends.	Current in-product data; no public refresh SLA found.	Creator account/ app feature where available.

Company / product	Direct panel / report	Signal and metric	Locales	Useful windows	Update / freshness	Access / price
TikTok Creative Center / Creative Suite Trends	Creative Suite Trends	Trending **hashtags**, videos and related creatives; hashtag pages show post/view counts and movement/rank. [12]	Region filters; live pages expose country-specific rankings.	Public URLs commonly accept periods such as 7d; other UI windows vary.	Dynamic/current.	Free/public browsing, although some detailed features may ask for login.
Pinterest Trends	Pinterest Trends	Search trends, save trends, shopping trends; normalized trend index 0–100; weekly/monthly/yearly change; audience-specific growing trends. [13]	Region selector; some features limited to regions.	Up to 2y historical; audience trends use past 90d; current page includes monthly and weekly growth. [14]	Audience-specific trends update daily. [14]	Public overview; business login unlocks audience-specific views/export.
Yandex Wordstat	Wordstat	Query counts containing phrase; percentage of all Yandex queries; region affinity; top queries. [16]	Particularly valuable for Russian-speaking/Yandex markets; regional/city filters.	Daily: last 60d; weekly/monthly selectable from 3 periods up to 5y; region report uses last 30d. [16]	Periodic current statistics; CSV export.	Yandex login required; free.

Company / product	Direct panel / report	Signal and metric	Locales	Useful windows	Update / freshness	Access / price
Naver DataLab	DataLab	Search-term trends plus **Shopping Insight popular search terms** and click trends; device/ gender/age filters. [17]	South Korea / Korean ecosystem.	Search trend presets include 1m, 3m, 1y and custom dates; daily/ weekly/ monthly. [17]	Daily pages visible; current public crawl showed data through Nov. 7. [17]	Public/free.
Baidu Index	Baidu Index	Weighted **search index**, related-demand graph, information/ media indices and demographics. Search index is computed from Baidu search frequency, not raw count. [18]	China / Chinese search behavior, with regional filtering.	Supports selected time ranges including documented “recent 30 days” examples. [18]	Current product; public methodology does not give a simple minute-level refresh SLA.	Login/ product access; professional edition exists.
Weibo hot search / topic index	Weibo hot-search help / Data Center	Real-time hot-search ranking; hot-word ranking; topic real-time heat based on reads/ discussions/ original authors; 1h/ 24h/7d/30d trend views. [19]	China / Chinese.	Real-time, 24h, 7d; topic pages additionally document 30d. [20]	Real-time/ dynamic.	Public pages with some account-dependent detail.

Company / product	Direct panel / report	Signal and metric	Locales	Useful windows	Update / freshness	Access / price
Google Ads Keyword Planner	Keyword Planner guide	Average monthly Google searches; keyword ideas; competition and bid metrics. Average monthly searches use the selected period/ location and default to a 12-month average. [21]	Country/ region/city and language targeting. [22]	Historical date range can be changed; forecasts are refreshed daily and use the previous 7–10 days adjusted for seasonality. [23]	Forecasts daily; volume statistics are historical/ rounded.	Google Ads account with billing setup required even for basic keyword ideas. [23]
AlsoAsked	AlsoAsked	Live Google **People Also Ask** questions and relationship graph; city/ country/ language targeting. [24]	Google-supported languages; country/city targeting.	Live query-time snapshot rather than fixed 7/30/90d ranking.	Vendor says PAA can change within hours after breaking news. [25]	Free credits; paid monthly plans; API on paid tiers. [26]
AnswerThePublic	AnswerThePublic	Search/ autocomplete-derived questions and suggestions across several sources; Search Listening can alert on new suggestions weekly. [27]	Multi-country/ language product.	Point-in-time searches + weekly monitoring.	Weekly alerting for changes/new suggestions. [28]	Free plan currently states 3 searches/ day; paid plans available. [29]

Company / product	Direct panel / report	Signal and metric	Locales	Useful windows	Update / freshness	Access / price
Exploding Topics	Methodology	Provider-curated emerging topics using multiple web/ social/search/ community sources; volume/ growth/ forecasting are provider models. [30]	Claims broad major-geography monitoring.	Long-term/ emerging rather than 24h news spikes; product supports trend-history views.	Continuous daily ingestion claimed by vendor. [31]	Limited free material; Pro starts from paid plans; API is a Business-plan add-on. [32]

Live, reproducible examples

The clearest **current query example** I could independently retrieve is Google Trends Trending Now for Greece. At retrieval on 8 November 2026, the public 24-hour page showed, among others, **"ελ νίνιο"** at **20K+ searches** and **+1,000%**, **"ποιοι γιορτάζουν σήμερα"** at **20K+ / +1,000%**, **"ερρικοσ πετιλον"** at **10K+ / +1,000%**, and **"marathon athens 2026"** at **500+ / +1,000%**. Those are bucketed counts for **surging** Google Search clusters in Greece over the selected 24-hour view, not Greece's absolute most-searched queries. [33]

Pinterest's public Southern Europe view, covering Greece, Italy, Malta, Portugal and Spain, showed **"unghie autunnali"** as a high-search-volume monthly trend, while examples in its search-trend table included **"carlos la bola negra"** and **"unas tendencia octubre"**, each displayed with **10,000%+ monthly growth** on the retrieved page. Pinterest explicitly says its trend data can reflect searches, saves, outbound clicks and other actions depending on the panel, so these should not be labeled "Google-like query volume." [34]

For South Korea, Naver DataLab's public **Shopping Insight** ranking showed **"경량패딩"** ("lightweight padded jacket") ranked #1 on November 7, 2026, followed by **"패딩조끼"** and **"후리스"**. This is a useful native-language demand signal, but it is specifically a **shopping-search ranking**, not a general Naver web-search leaderboard. [17]

For TikTok, the public UK Creative Suite page retrieved on November 8 exposed **#bonfirenight** with **22.3K posts / 48M views**, **#fireworks** with **39.3K posts / 58.3M views**, and **#november** with **25K posts / 71.3M views**. These are concrete current English-region examples, but they are **hashtag content metrics**, not search queries; therefore they are useful for "what content is circulating," not for your task "what is searched." [35]

Recommended shortlist and solution cards

Google Trends: baseline cross-language demand detector

Exact job. Use Google Trends Trending Now to detect new/surging search demand, then Explore to test whether a candidate is persistent, geographically concentrated, seasonal, or associated with rising related queries. Google's data is a sampled, anonymized and aggregated subset of actual Google searches; Explore is normalized rather than absolute. [36]

Mode and minimum agent capability. Manual browser is sufficient. A medium agent needs only: open URL, select region/window, read table, follow a query into Explore, export/copy results and preserve the page URL. No account or API key is required for the public path. The public Trending Now page supports CSV and RSS export, which is preferable to scraping DOM if the agent can download files. [4]

Procedure. Set native market first; collect the current 24h list; record exact query/cluster, search-volume bucket, growth %, start time and active/ended status; repeat with 7d; open only niche-relevant items in Explore; compare 7/30/90d; capture related **Top** and **Rising** separately; deduplicate transliterations/spelling variants only after preserving originals; and attach the direct Trends URL plus extraction timestamp. Google defines Top as the most frequently co-searched terms and Rising as those with greatest growth versus the previous comparable period. [37]

Validation. Check the same candidate against YouTube/TikTok/Pinterest/Yandex/Naver depending on market. A "Breakout" in Explore means >5,000% growth, but it can originate from a tiny base, so validate with actual search-result activity, video comments or a second source. [38]

What not to infer. A score of 100 is not 100 searches; two markets showing the same 100 do not imply equal volumes; a Trending Now surge is not equivalent to "most popular term of the month"; Trends can include statistical noise at low volumes. [8]

YouTube Studio Trends: best native "demand plus gap" source for YouTube

Exact job. This is the most directly useful native product for questions 1 and 3: it shows top searches related to your audience/saved topics and explicitly marks **Content gaps for Shorts**, where viewers are not finding enough exact, relevant or high-quality results. It also shows recent videos and watched-on-YouTube examples, allowing demand and supply to be examined together. [10]

Mode and requirements. It requires a YouTube channel/Studio login; some insights are restricted by country/language/device and may simply not appear. The meaningful current window documented for top searches is 28 days. A browser agent must use an authenticated browser profile; an MCP name alone does not confer Studio access. [10]

Procedure. In Studio → Analytics → Trends, save a native-language topic; export or transcribe Top Searches, recent videos and Content Gaps; for each gap, open normal YouTube search in an incognito/non-personalized context where practical; inspect the first 10–20 results for age, language, exactness, views, recency and whether the answer actually satisfies the question; then inspect transcripts and comments for unanswered follow-ups. The gap flag is a discovery hint, not proof that you can successfully fill the gap. [10]

What not to infer. Studio's Top Searches are audience/saves-oriented, not a neutral global ranking, and its interest categories do not give raw search frequency. [10]

TikTok Creator Search Insights plus Comment Insights: native search-demand path

Exact job. Creator Search Insights is the TikTok product to use when you need *search behavior*. It surfaces often-searched topics, a popularity score and a Content Gap filter for topics searched often but represented by relatively few videos. Separately, TikTok Comment Insights uses AI to summarize recurring comment topics, audience suggestions and viewer questions on your own and, in some contexts, other creators' posts. [39]

Mode and requirements. Creator Search Insights is account/region-dependent. Comment Insights is also not available everywhere and requires age eligibility. It can be accessed in TikTok/TikTok Studio and, for supported workflows, through the web Studio interface. [39]

Procedure. Query the native-language niche in Creator Search Insights; save the topic, popularity label/score and whether Content Gap is present; then open top relevant videos and use Comment Insights or the raw comments to collect explicit questions, objections and requested follow-ups. Cross-check the same terms in Google Trends or regional search tools before labeling a TikTok signal as broad-market demand. [39]

What not to infer. TikTok Creative Center's hashtags, songs and videos do not substitute for Creator Search Insights. Creative Center explicitly describes its Trends product as trending **hashtags**, so a hashtag rank or view count should never be reported as "TikTok search volume." [40]

Pinterest Trends: exceptionally useful for intent before publication

Exact job. Pinterest is useful for visual/tutorial/lifestyle channels because search and save behavior often precede a project, purchase or planned activity. The Trends product exposes search keywords, weekly/monthly/yearly changes, a normalized trend graph, popular Pins and—where sufficient audience exists—growing trends among your own engaged users/followers over 90 days. [14]

Mode. Much of the site can be browsed publicly. A Pinterest Business login is needed for audience-specific insight and CSV export. Audience-trend data updates daily. [14]

Procedure. Select region first; collect top monthly trends and high weekly/monthly growth terms; open keyword detail; record search-trend curve and related terms; inspect Popular Pins to establish current supply quality; then search YouTube/TikTok for the same native phrase. That last step converts Pinterest from an "interest" signal into a candidate video gap. [14]

What not to infer. Pinterest normalizes the series, with each plotted term's highest point indexed to 100. Cross-term or cross-country arithmetic using those scores as raw volumes is invalid. [14]

Yandex Wordstat, Naver DataLab and Baidu Index: regional sources worth keeping

For Russian-speaking audiences, **Yandex Wordstat** is unusually valuable because it exposes query counts, share of all Yandex queries, daily history for the last 60 days, regional distribution over 30 days and CSV

export. It requires a Yandex login but not a paid API. That makes it a stronger magnitude check than Google Trends for Yandex-heavy audiences. [16]

For Korea, **Naver DataLab** supplies a native search-trend tool with one-month, three-month, one-year and custom windows and demographic/device filters; its Shopping Insight also exposes ranked shopping search terms daily. It is free and public, and is one of the easiest regional panels for a browser-first agent. [17]

For mainland China, **Baidu Index** should be treated as a modeled index product. Its documentation distinguishes Search Index, Information Index and Media Index and describes related-demand graphs based on query relationships and demand strength. For Chinese social attention, Weibo adds real-time hot-search and topic-heat signals, including 1h, 24h, 7d and 30d trends. Those are complementary attention measures, not interchangeable raw query counts. [41]

AlsoAsked: best compact “question expansion” service

Exact job. Once a need has been found, AlsoAsked is effective at revealing the question graph around it from live Google People Also Ask results. It supports country, city and language targeting and explicitly maps relationships between questions rather than merely listing autocomplete completions. [24]

Mode. Browser use is enough for occasional research; free search credits exist, while paid plans add higher usage/export/API. The API becomes worthwhile when the same seed list must be re-run weekly or across dozens of locales. [26]

Procedure. Feed a phrase already validated in Trends/Studio/Wordstat; export the question tree; cluster only after preserving exact wording and locale; then search the 5–10 highest-value questions on YouTube and the target platform; score existing answers for exactness, recency, evidence and whether commenters still ask the same question.

What not to infer. PAA membership proves that Google considers the question relevant enough to surface, but it is not a public search-volume number. Use Keyword Planner/Ahrefs/Semrush only when approximate magnitude materially changes the decision. [42]

Browser agents, MCPs, skills and extraction tooling

Comparison of browser automation candidates

Tool	Mode	Keys/models	License / activity	Good fit here	Main risk
Vercel `agent-browser`	Local CLI, skill, stdio MCP; can attach to Chrome/CDP or cloud providers.	Local CLI itself does not require an external LLM API because the *outer agent* issues commands; installation needs Node/npm plus Chrome for Testing. [43]	Apache-2.0; package metadata showed v0.38.1 in the retrieved repo; issues were active as recently as Nov. 7, 2026. [44]	**Best overall recommendation** for a shell-capable medium agent: compact accessibility snapshots, deterministic CLI commands, session/auth support, CSV download.	Google can trigger CAPTCHA/verification under automation; an open issue documents exactly that. [45]
Stagehand / `browse` CLI	`browse` CLI+skill, SDK in TS/Python/Go, Browserbase cloud, hosted MCP.	**Local `browse --local`: no LLM key or Browserbase account needed.** Hosted MCP requires Browserbase API key; cloud SDK may use Browserbase Model Gateway. [46]	MIT; active project/issues in Nov. 2026. [47]	Excellent alternative to `agent-browser`; clearer separation of local keyless CLI vs hosted MCP than many projects.	Hosted path adds vendor account/cost; real-world CAPTCHA/login flows remain a documented pain point. [48]
Browser Use	Hosted agent, CLI, local Python/TS library, cloud browser.	Local autonomous agent normally needs an LLM configuration; Browser Use gateway/cloud needs `BROWSER_USE_API_KEY`. Cloud browser advertises $0.02/browser-hour plus network traffic. [49]	MIT; org showed updates Nov. 5, 2026. [50]	Useful when you want the framework itself to reason and operate, or need stealth/proxies/CAPTCHA support.	More infrastructure than necessary for simple dashboard reading; full cost includes model calls, proxy/network use and vendor dependence.

Tool	Mode	Keys/models	License / activity	Good fit here	Main risk
Microsoft Playwright MCP	Local MCP; Playwright accessibility snapshots.	Node 20+ and MCP-capable client; no vision model required. [51]	Microsoft project, actively documented.	Good if your agent shell already standardizes on MCP.	MCP schemas consume more context; the project itself now notes CLI+skills can be more token-efficient for coding agents. [52]

A critical operational distinction is that **browser control does not prove demand-data access**. `agent-browser`, Stagehand and Playwright can click a Trends page, but they do not independently define Google's metrics; conversely, a "Google Trends MCP" may return structured data while depending on undocumented endpoints or a commercial scraping provider. Those are different trust layers.

Demand-specific MCPs and repositories

HasData Google Trends MCP is a hosted wrapper returning interest-over-time, regional interest and top/rising queries as JSON. Its repository says it requires a HasData API key, with 1,000 free credits/month equating to about 100 Trends calls. This is convenient for agents with MCP but should be considered a third-party data-access service, not an official Google interface. [53]

`purahmanian/google-trends-mcp` is a no-key open-source alternative, but the project explicitly states that it calls undocumented internal Google Trends endpoints and may break if Google changes or rate-limits them. That disclosure makes it useful for experiments but unsuitable as the sole production evidence path. [54]

HasData TikTok MCP exposes public profiles, videos, comments and keyword search as JSON without a TikTok developer account, but it still needs a HasData key and is a scraping service. Its keyword-search result fields include play/like/comment/share counts, which are valuable for supply/content analysis; they should not be reinterpreted as Creator Search Insights search-volume data. [55]

Reddit MCP projects require extra caution in November 2026. Reddit officially stopped accepting new public Data API requests on October 31, 2026, will begin removing unregistered access on January 12, 2027 and plans to end remaining public Data API access in March 2027. Therefore a repository claiming "no Reddit API key" by using old `.json` endpoints is structurally fragile. [56] One project, `bigideas-db/reddit-mcp-server`, says it works by handing requests to a Chrome extension using the user's logged-in browser; that is technically plausible as a browser-assisted path but remains the vendor's claim, not an official Reddit guarantee. [57]

For YouTube transcripts, `youtube-transcript-api` remains a practical no-key option: it retrieves public/manual or autogenerated subtitles through an undocumented YouTube web-client route. The maintainer explicitly warns that cloud IPs are frequently blocked and that the undocumented endpoint can change at any time. [58] A smaller MCP wrapper, `ChristophLanganke/youtube-mcp`, similarly exposes public-video transcripts without credentials and uses an InnerTube/player endpoint; public search/channel operations require a Google API key and personal-account operations require OAuth. [59]

For broader video metadata/comments/subtitles, `yt-dlp` can retrieve subtitles and, where supported, comments; its YouTube extractor supports comment sorting and limits, and can use cookies from an existing browser. That is useful for content-gap auditing but has the same brittleness and platform-policy concerns as any web extractor. [60] The official YouTube Data API is preferable when you need stable structured comments at scale: `commentThreads.list` costs one quota unit and can sort by time or relevance and filter by search terms. By contrast, the official `captions.download` endpoint is **not** a general public-transcript API: it requires authorization to edit the video. [61]

Reproducible workflow for a medium agent

The recommended procedure is intentionally browser-first and does not assume arbitrary API keys. It is a funnel, not an autonomous scraping architecture.

1. **Define the native market before the topic.** Record country/region, language, platform and current extraction timestamp. For multilingual channels, run native spellings separately rather than translating after collection. Google itself distinguishes exact search terms from language-agnostic Topics; the latter are useful for cross-language concept comparison but can hide wording differences that matter for video titles. [6]

2. **Discover demand from two independent signal types.** Start with Google Trending Now/Explore plus one native platform or regional source: YouTube Studio Trends for YouTube, Creator Search Insights for TikTok, Pinterest Trends for Pinterest-heavy subjects, Wordstat for Yandex markets, DataLab for Korea, Baidu/Weibo for China. Preserve raw metrics and never convert them into a shared score. [62]

3. **Classify each signal as Popular / Rising / New.** “Popular” requires a level metric such as rank, query count, 12-month search estimate or current audience Top Search. “Rising” requires an explicit comparison basis—Google Trends gives change against the prior period; Pinterest gives weekly/monthly/yearly changes. “New” requires evidence of onset, such as Google Trending Now’s Started timestamp, or a previously absent query in repeated snapshots. Do not call a high-growth old query “new” unless first appearance can actually be established. [63]

4. **Turn demand into questions.** Use related Google searches, YouTube search suggestions, TikTok Creator Search Insights, AlsoAsked/PAA, native community search and comment questions. Exact wording should be stored before clustering. AlsoAsked is useful here because it maps live PAA relationships rather than only autocomplete strings. [64]

5. **Test under-satisfaction rather than assuming it.** Search the exact native phrase on the target video platform. For the top 10–20 results, record title, date, views, duration, language, exact-match

relevance, evidence quality and whether the video actually answers the question. YouTube Studio's native Content Gap is a particularly strong starting signal because YouTube defines a gap as cases where viewers cannot find results, an exact match, or sufficiently relevant/current/high-quality videos. [10]

6. **Read substance, not titles.** Where transcripts are visible, inspect them directly in the browser. If the environment supports safe CLI tooling, `youtube-transcript-api`/YouTube MCP/`yt-dlp` can accelerate transcription, while official YouTube commentThreads API is preferable for repeatable large-scale comment extraction. For TikTok, native Comment Insights can summarize questions and suggestions where available; otherwise sample raw comments manually or with an approved/defensible extractor. [65]

7. **Identify the missing answer.** A gap is stronger when at least two conditions hold: native platform labels a gap; search volume/growth is meaningful; current results are old or weak; repeated comment questions remain unanswered; or another region/language has a good answer while the target language does not. This is an analytical rule, not a provider metric.

8. **Collect primary material only after choosing the need.** Prefer official documentation, government datasets, standards bodies, company disclosures, papers and first-party statements. Community posts establish what users are confused about; they should not automatically become factual sources for the eventual answer.

9. **Retain provenance.** Every candidate should leave a small evidence bundle: exact native query, locale, platform, time window, extraction time, raw metric, direct URL, screenshot/export where permitted, source type, duplicates/variants and a one-sentence explanation of why the result qualifies as Popular, Rising or New. This prevents a later agent from silently turning a Pinterest index into "searches" or a TikTok view count into "demand."

Browser-first path with no mandatory API keys

A concrete keyless route is available **provided the agent has shell access and may launch a local browser**:

`agent-browser` → open public Google Trends → set region/time → snapshot/read rows → follow candidate into Explore → export CSV → open Pinterest Trends or Naver DataLab → corroborate → open YouTube search → inspect result pages/transcripts/comments.

`agent-browser` itself operates through shell commands and accessibility-tree snapshots, and its local path does not require a model API key because the calling agent is the model. It also ships version-matched skills and a stdio MCP mode. [66]

A second keyless local route is Stagehand's current `browse` **CLI + skill** with `browse ... --local`; its README explicitly says that mode needs neither an LLM key nor a Browserbase account. Hosted Browserbase MCP is a separate product path and **does** require a Browserbase API key. [67]

I did **not** execute either local tool in this research session, because the requested constraint was to study rather than install and the present Deep Research environment is not evidence that your agents have shell/browser-control privileges. Therefore these two paths are **documentation-verified, not environment-tested here**.

For an agent that lacks shell/MCP but has an ordinary browser, the same workflow remains viable manually: public Google Trends, Pinterest Trends, Naver DataLab, Bilibili rankings, Weibo hot pages and ordinary platform search can be read directly. Bilibili's public ranking explicitly says it is dynamically updated from recent content-quality/performance signals, which makes it useful for "what is being watched," though again not for search demand. [68]

What APIs and paid services are actually worth buying

APIs become superior to browser work when you need **scheduled repeatability, hundreds of seeds/locales, stable structured comments, or historical snapshots**. Google's official Trends BigQuery dataset is preferable to scraping if its Top-25 coverage is sufficient; YouTube Data API is preferable for comments if quotas and Google Cloud setup are acceptable; paid AlsoAsked/API access is valuable for recurring PAA monitoring; and a keyword suite such as Ahrefs or Semrush is justified when estimated magnitude, SERP competition and historical keyword databases matter enough to pay for them. [69]

Ahrefs currently describes search volume as a modeled 12-month average built on Google Keyword Planner data; its Starter tier was documented at $29/month in September 2026, with Lite at $129, while API/MCP capabilities are associated with higher plans. [70] Semrush's Keyword Overview similarly provides national/global/local monthly Google-search estimates, 12-month trend, questions and related keyword data; these are good for scale and competition but much slower-moving than Google Trending Now. [71]

Google Keyword Planner is an especially useful "magnitude sanity check" because it comes from Google Ads, but access now requires completing Ads account setup with billing information. Its average monthly searches are rounded, location-dependent and typically averaged over 12 months; its *forecasts*, not its historical volume, are refreshed daily from the previous 7–10 days. [72]

I would **not** buy a general "trend discovery" subscription as the first expense. Exploding Topics is useful for long-horizon discovery but its trend identification and forecasts are proprietary provider outputs, assembled from many web sources; it should lead to primary-platform validation rather than replace it. [30]

Remaining gaps and risk controls

The largest unresolved gap is **authenticated, country-specific access to TikTok Creator Search Insights and YouTube Studio Trends**. Their documentation establishes the functions, but the current exact rankings depend on the user's account, audience, rollout, language and region. Without logging into your channel/accounts, a research agent should report those paths as "available for in-account verification," not invent current results. [73]

Meta is weaker for your specific need. I found current official Instagram guidance centered on account performance, reach, engagement and personalized best-practice recommendations, but not a general creator-facing public database of typed Instagram search queries analogous to Creator Search Insights or

YouTube Studio Trends. Consequently, Instagram/Facebook should be treated primarily as **content-performance and community-question sources**, not as first-class query-demand panels unless Meta exposes a relevant account-specific feature in your dashboard. Meta's Best Practices product is explicitly an educational/personalized performance hub rather than a search-query leaderboard. [74]

Browser automation remains fragile around login, anti-bot controls and platform terms. `agent-browser` has a documented Google CAPTCHA issue; Stagehand's issue tracker contains real-world CAPTCHA/login requests; `youtube-transcript-api` warns of cloud-IP blocking; Reddit is actively migrating away from broad public Data API access. These are strong reasons to make the browser workflow **observable and restartable**, preserve exports/screenshots, and prefer official APIs/exports when a workflow becomes recurring rather than attempting to "stealth" every site. [75]

The practical shortlist is therefore: **Google Trends** for universal discovery; **YouTube Studio Trends** for YouTube demand/gaps; **TikTok Creator Search Insights + Comment Insights** for TikTok search/questions; **Pinterest Trends** for planning-oriented intent; **Wordstat / Naver DataLab / Baidu Index + Weibo** for regional correction; **AlsoAsked** for question expansion; and `agent-browser` **or Stagehand** `browse --local` only as the transport layer when an agent actually has shell/browser access. Browser Use is valuable when you intentionally want a more autonomous hosted/browser-agent stack, but it is not the cheapest or simplest default for routine demand reconnaissance. [76]

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